



Warning sign

A sign in Cambodia warns travelers to beware of mines. Unexploded ordnance remained an unseen danger throughout Indochina, and represented just one of many ways in which the landscape was weaponized against the communist forces during the First Indochina War.

» AFTER

Vietnam made discernible political and economic progress as it moved into the 21st century.

PROGRESS AND STRUGGLE

Although it had to contend with land devastated by war, a brutal dictatorial government, a burgeoning population, and the costs of hegemony over its neighbors, Vietnam was still able to prosper as it moved **into the 21st century**, especially as it embraced a new economic system. Meanwhile, Cambodia and Laos, two of the poorest, most corrupt, and dysfunctional countries in the world, continued to suffer from the impact and legacy of the Indochina Wars.